Keychron K8 Keyboard

Wireless mechanical keyboard, tenkeyless, 87 keys

Setup and service guide

How to recognise this device

A compact mechanical keyboard with 87 keys and no number pad. The keycaps are dark grey and light grey, with an orange Escape key on many units. The word Keychron is printed on the underside.

On the left edge there is a USB-C port and two small slide switches: one marked Win/Android and Mac/iOS, the other marked BT, Off and Cable. The top-right key carries a light bulb symbol.

Parts and tools

- Keychron K8 keyboard
- USB-C cable
- Keycap puller (wire loop tool)
- Switch puller (metal tweezers tool)
- Spare Windows and Mac keycaps

Sample document written to demonstrate the Hermes Glasses machine guide. It is not the manufacturer's manual; check the official manual before servicing a real device.

Section 1. Connect by cable

Step 1. Find the two slide switches on the left edge of the keyboard, next to the USB-C port.

Step 2. Slide the operating system switch to Mac/iOS for a Mac, or to Win/Android for a Windows PC.

Step 3. Slide the mode switch to Cable.

Step 4. Plug the USB-C cable into the keyboard and into the computer. The keyboard is ready when the backlight comes on.

Section 2. Pair by Bluetooth

Step 5. Slide the mode switch on the left edge to BT.

Step 6. Hold the Fn key and the number 1 key together for four seconds, until the backlight under the 1 key flashes quickly.

Step 7. On the computer, open Bluetooth settings and choose Keychron K8. The flashing stops when pairing is complete.

Step 8. To pair a second or third device, repeat with Fn and 2, or Fn and 3. The keyboard remembers three devices.

Step 9. To switch between paired devices, press Fn and the device's number once, without holding.

Section 3. Replace a keycap

Caution. Pull keycaps straight up. Rocking a keycap sideways can bend the switch stem.

Step 10. Take the keycap puller, the tool with two wire loops.

Step 11. Push the wire loops down over the keycap until they click under two opposite corners.

Step 12. Pull straight up with steady force. The keycap comes off the switch stem.

Step 13. Line up the new keycap with the cross-shaped stem and press down firmly until it seats.

Step 14. For the long keys - space bar, Enter, Shift and Backspace - lift both ends evenly, because they sit on a stabiliser bar.

Section 4. Replace a switch (hot-swappable model only)

Caution. Unplug the cable and slide the mode switch to Off before removing a switch. Check both metal pins are straight before inserting a switch; a bent pin will not make contact and can damage the socket.

Step 15. Remove the keycap from the switch, following Section 3.

Step 16. Take the switch puller, the metal tweezers tool. Grip the switch on its top and bottom edges, where the two plastic tabs are.

Step 17. Squeeze to release the tabs and pull the switch straight up out of the plate.

Step 18. Inspect the new switch. The two metal pins must be straight and parallel.

Step 19. Line the pins up with the two holes in the socket, then press the switch straight down until it clicks into the plate.

Step 20. Refit the keycap, switch the keyboard on and press the key to test it. If nothing happens, remove the switch and check for a bent pin.

Section 5. Backlight, battery and reset

Step 21. Press the light bulb key at the top right to cycle through the backlight effects.

Step 22. Press Fn and the light bulb key together to turn the backlight off or on.

Step 23. Press Fn and B to check the battery. The power light shows green above seventy percent, blue between thirty and seventy, and flashes red below thirty.

Step 24. Charge with the USB-C cable. The light next to the port is red while charging and green when full.

Step 25. To factory reset the keyboard, hold Fn, J and Z together for four seconds until the backlight flashes.